FLEXIPLE · AI PRODUCT ASSIGNMENT · OCTOBER 2026

Groundtruth

One source of truth for India's GCC market, starting where it matters most: the decision on where and how to set up.

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Live prototype
groundtruth-bay.vercel.app

SUMMARY

PROBLEM

Every GCC decision runs on numbers that disagree

GCC counts vary 3.9×, office rents 37%, and most headline incentives skip the metros where GCCs actually go.

OPPORTUNITY

Own the first-time setup decision

High stakes (₹6.7 Cr a year between metros for 60 engineers), time-bound, and unserved by today's directories.

SOLUTION

Groundtruth, a setup planner

Ranks cities by fully-loaded cost, counts only incentives you qualify for, and traces every number to its source.

WHY FLEXIPLE

It already has 536 verified GCCs, pay data on 29.9M professionals and a setup service that turns plans into revenue.

01 · PROBLEM · THE MARKET

Big, concentrated, and still growing

2,117
GCCs, running 3,728 units (FY26)

2.36M
people employed

$98.4B
revenue, up from $64.6B in FY24

92%
sit in six cities

583
mid-market GCCs, plus 504 PE-backed

New entrants keep coming

Roughly 55–100 new GCCs a year, and 35% of mid-market GCCs are under two years old. Recent entrants: Vanguard, Costco, UBS, Medtronic.

States are chasing them

Ten states have GCC policies or frameworks, targeting about 1,380 new GCCs and 1.18M jobs by 2029–31.

Sources: Zinnov-nasscom 2026; Zinnov 2025; CBRE via Entrepreneur; Ceipal

Every setup step brings a new stranger

Step	Weeks	Who sells it	What the buyer must know
Strategy and city	1–4	Big 4, Zinnov, Everest, ANSR	Cost by city, talent depth
Entity, compliance	5–10	Law and CA firms, EOR providers	Which model, when to incorporate
Workspace	7–14	CBRE, JLL, Knight Frank, coworking	What rent really is
Hiring	9–18	Recruiters, talent platforms	Pay benchmarks, notice periods
Go-live or transfer	18–24+	BOT builders: Infosys, HCLTech	Who has actually delivered
Across all steps	—	10 states with GCC policies	Which incentives apply to us

Each seller knows its own slice. Nobody holds the whole picture for the buyer, so newcomers rely on referrals.

Timeline: Wisemonk setup guide (vendor). Providers: press, Everest PEAK 2025

Even the basics depend on who you ask

Question	Lowest published	Highest published	Spread
GCCs in India	536, Flexiple verified	2,117, Zinnov–nasscom	3.9×
GCCs in Bengaluru	437, Flexiple	900+, JLL	2.1×
Mumbai rent, Q1 2026	₹125, Knight Frank	₹170.8, CRE Matrix	37%
Bengaluru rent, Q1 2026	₹100.6, Knight Frank	₹132.6, CRE Matrix	32%
New GCCs a year	~55, Zinnov	~240, HFS annualised	4.4×
Entity break-even	25 people, Flexiple	50 people, Wisemonk	2×

Why they differ: companies vs centres, different dates, and sellers with a stake in the answer. No one shows the spread, so a newcomer cannot tell which number applies to them.

Rents in ₹/sq ft/month. All 30 sources are listed in the prototype

The buyer has the most pain and least help

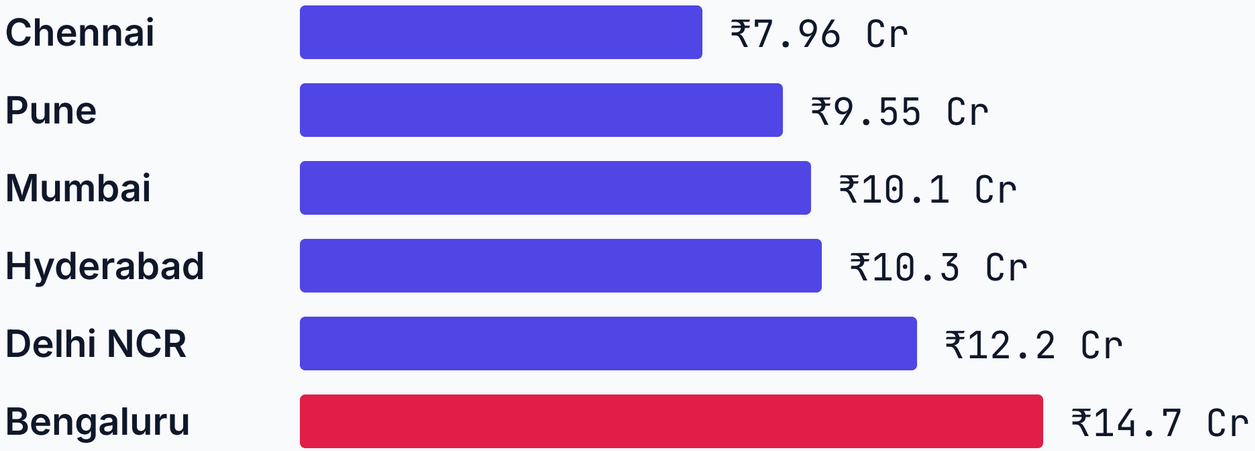
Who	How it hurts	How much	What they do today
First-time buyer	Picks city, model and partners on referrals	₹6.7 Cr/yr gap across metros for 60 engineers; rents off up to 37%	Big 4 advisors, $49–$6,499 reports, referrals
Service providers	Can't reach buyers early or prove delivery	7 of 12 claims in our sample are self-reported; 0 client-verified	Event sponsorships, content, lead databases
State governments	Incentives sit in PDFs, unseen at shortlist time	Targets imply ~275 new GCCs a year; the market makes 55–100	Roadshows, MoUs, policy PDFs
Expanding GCCs	Pay benchmarks go stale; offers get declined	Attrition adds 15–20% to cost per engineer (vendor estimate)	Analyst reports, peer networks

Providers and states have budgets and sales teams to cope. The first-time buyer has neither, and makes the decision that locks in cost for years.

Cost gap from the prototype (slide 07). Sources: CBRE, Zinnov, Wisemonk

60 engineers, six metros, ₹6.7 Cr apart

Year-one net cost: salaries, 12% on-costs, office space, minus incentives you qualify for



18 of 60 senior. Pay medians are city-wide, not role-matched: this shows the method, not a city recommendation.

93–95%

of the bill is talent. City choice is a pay decision first.

₹0

in incentives at 60 people. Each state's threshold or zone rules them out.

0.9%

of year-one cost: Pune's incentives even at 120 people.

02 · OPPORTUNITIES

Five ways in, ranked

Opportunity	Pain	Urgency	Who pays	Flexiple's edge	Competition	Rank
Setup decision engine	High	Dated decision	Setup deals	Pay data + setup arm	Nothing built	1
Provider evidence layer	High	Each vendor pick	Providers	Needs neutral stance	Paywalled reports	2
Upcoming-GCC lead signals	Medium	Continuous	Providers	48 centres tracked	GCC Explorer	3
State demand insights	Medium	Policy cycles	States	Weak today	Nothing; slow B2G	4
Directory or news site	Low	Low	Advertisers	536 profiles	3+ players	Skip

Why the setup decision comes first

It is the moment of highest intent. Leads, evidence and state insight all feed on the demand it creates.

Why not another directory

GCC Explorer, Business of GCC and GCC Pulse already list GCCs. A list does not tell a buyer what to do.

Competition checked Oct 2026: gccexplorer.com, businessofgcc.com, gcc-pulse.com, Everest

Start with the first-time buyer

FIRST USER

The person who owns the India decision at a mid-market or PE-backed company planning its first centre of 20–200 people

- No India team, no Big 4 budget
- A dated decision that locks in cost for years
- Every plan is a qualified Flexiple lead

583 mid-market GCCs **35%** set up in 2 years **504** PE-backed

THEN THE FLYWHEEL

1. Buyers plan for free
2. Plans become structured briefs: demand data
3. Providers pay for briefs and earn evidence grades
4. States pay to appear in the cost math

Better data brings the next buyer

Sources: Zinnov-nasscom 2026; Zinnov 2025; Flexiple GCC pages

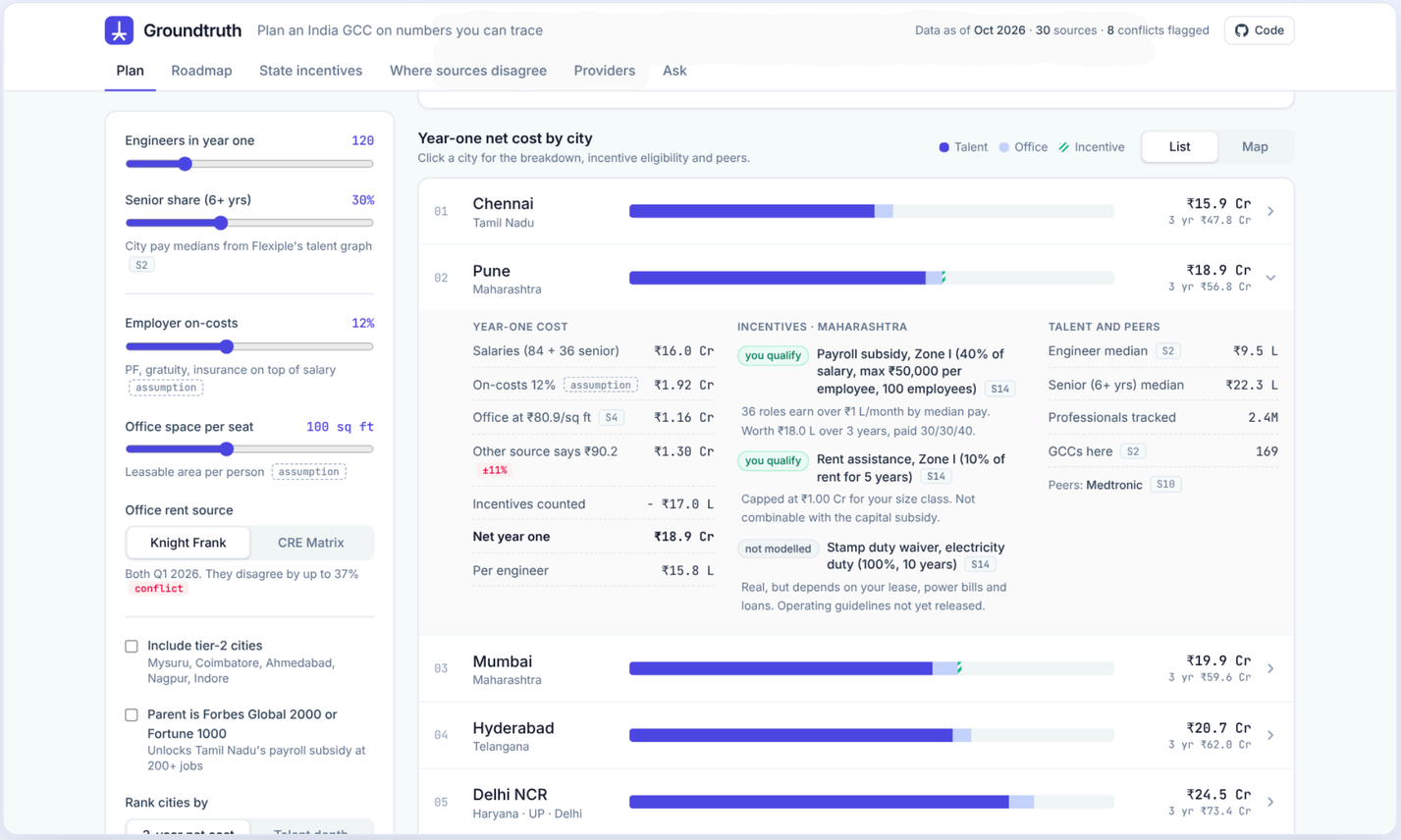
03 · SOLUTION

Groundtruth: plan on numbers you can trace

Module	The buyer's question	In the working prototype
Planner	Which city, and what will it cost?	11 cities, live controls, list or map
Incentive engine	What do we actually qualify for?	9 state policies, rules per city
Tier-2 + India map	Is a smaller city worth it?	5 tier-2 cities, estimates labelled
Roadmap	How long, and in what order?	Week-by-week Gantt by team size
Break-even	When do we form our own entity?	Derived from vendors' own numbers
Source ledger	Which number should I trust?	8 conflicts, 30 sources
Provider evidence	Who has really delivered?	A–D grades, 10 providers
Ask	Anything else, with proof?	Answer first, then sourced facts

Built as a real product: Next.js, TypeScript and Tailwind on Vercel, with 21 unit tests and CI. In production it would run on Flexiple's live talent graph.

The planner, working



Ranks cities by 3-year net cost or by talent depth.

Assumptions sit in dashed chips you can change.

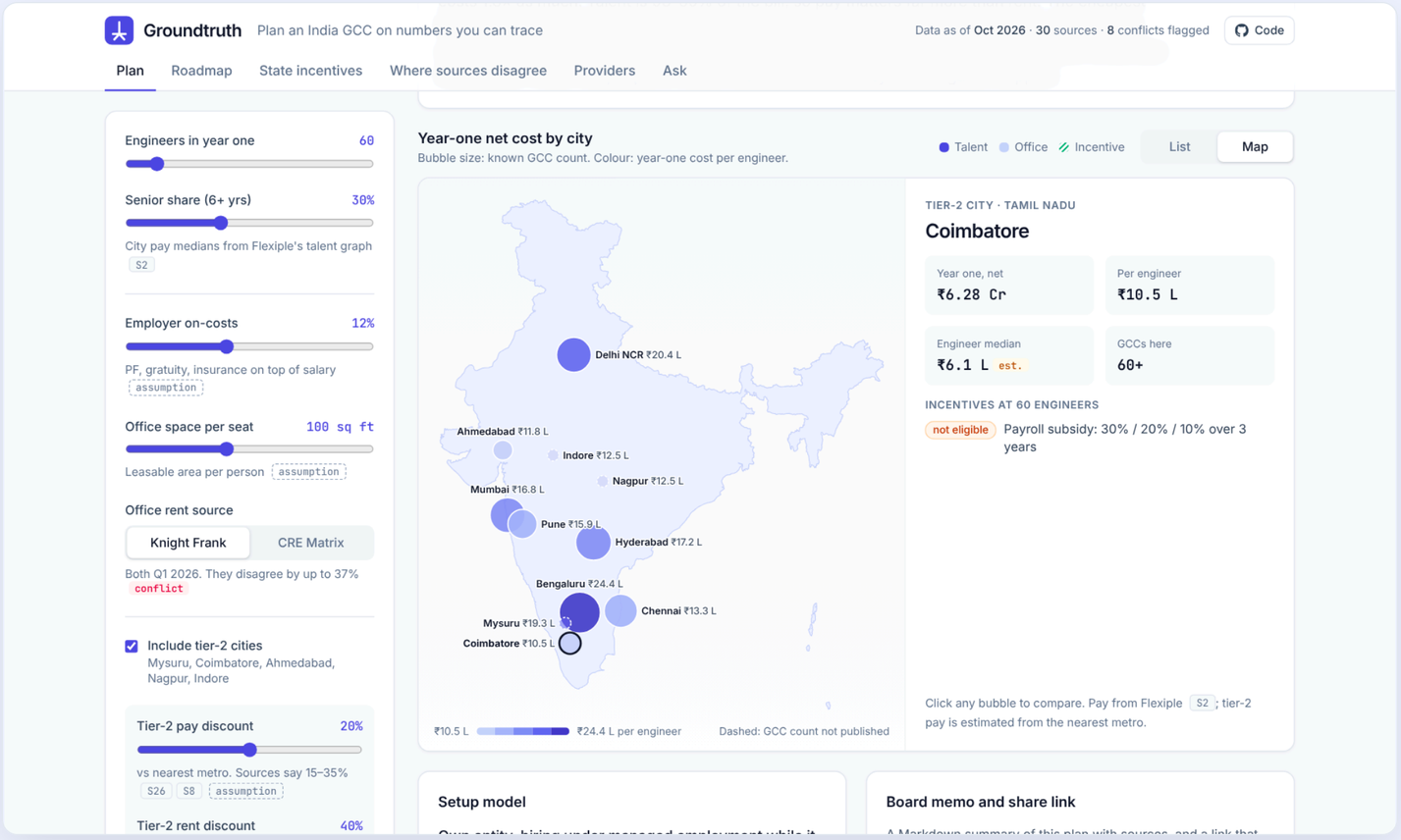
At 120 engineers Maharashtra's payroll and rent support switch on, with the exact reason.

Shareable scenario link and a Markdown board memo.

`Open the prototype`

Screenshot: 120 engineers, metros only

Beyond the metros, on a map

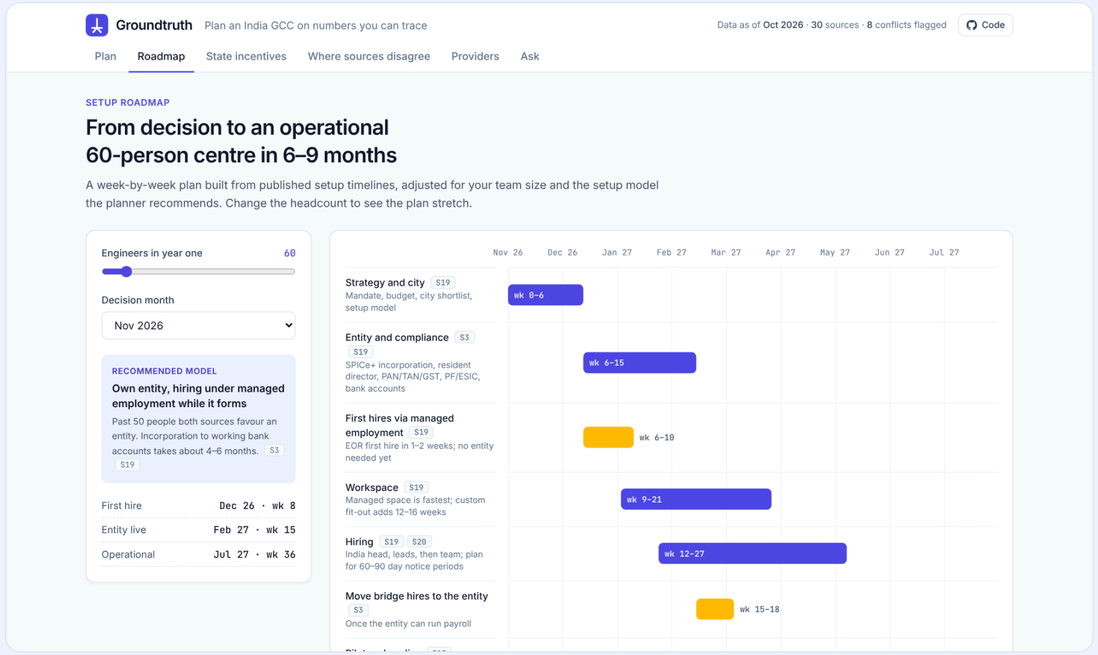


Five tier-2 cities: Mysuru, Coimbatore, Ahmedabad, Nagpur, Indore.

Incentives are richer here: Mysuru gets Karnataka's rent and EPF support; Nagpur gets Maharashtra's Zone II rates.

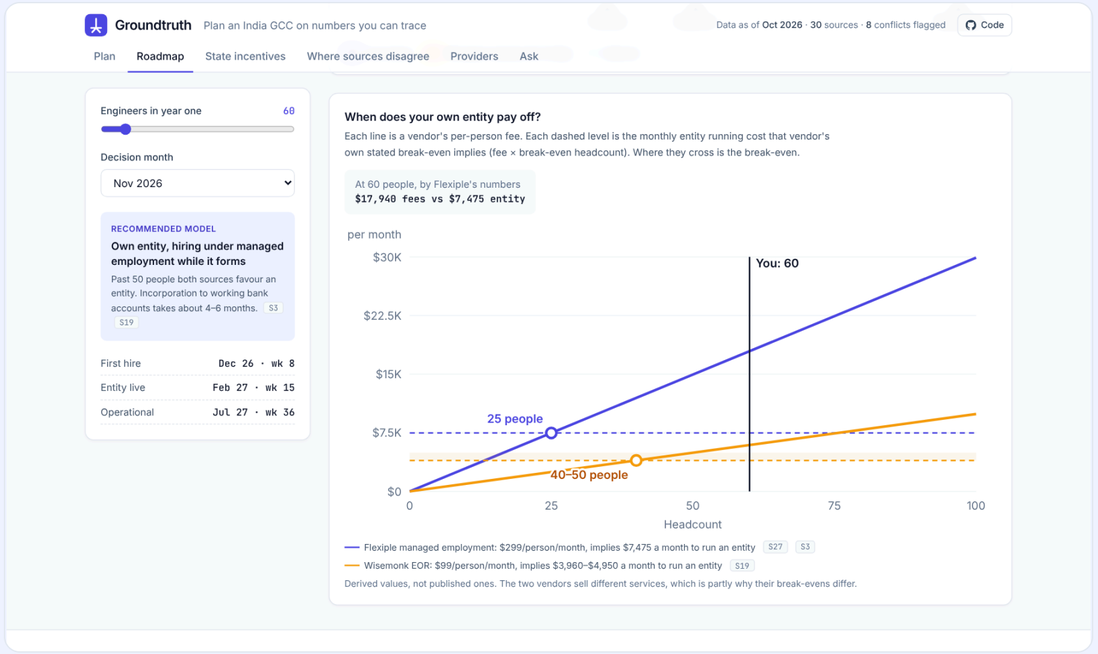
No source publishes tier-2 pay, so it is an editable estimate, labelled "est." everywhere.

Roadmap and break-even



Week-by-week roadmap

Stretches with team size; first hires start under managed employment.



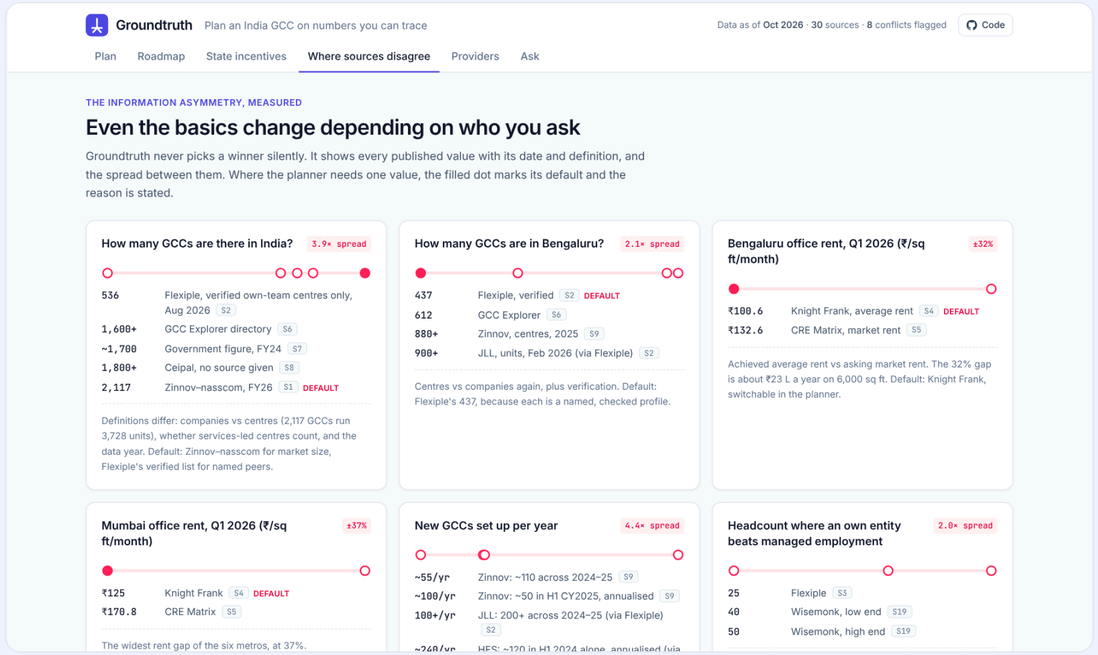
Break-even, derived

Fee × stated break-even = the entity cost each vendor implies.

Timelines: Wisemonk. Fees and break-evens: Flexiple, Wisemonk

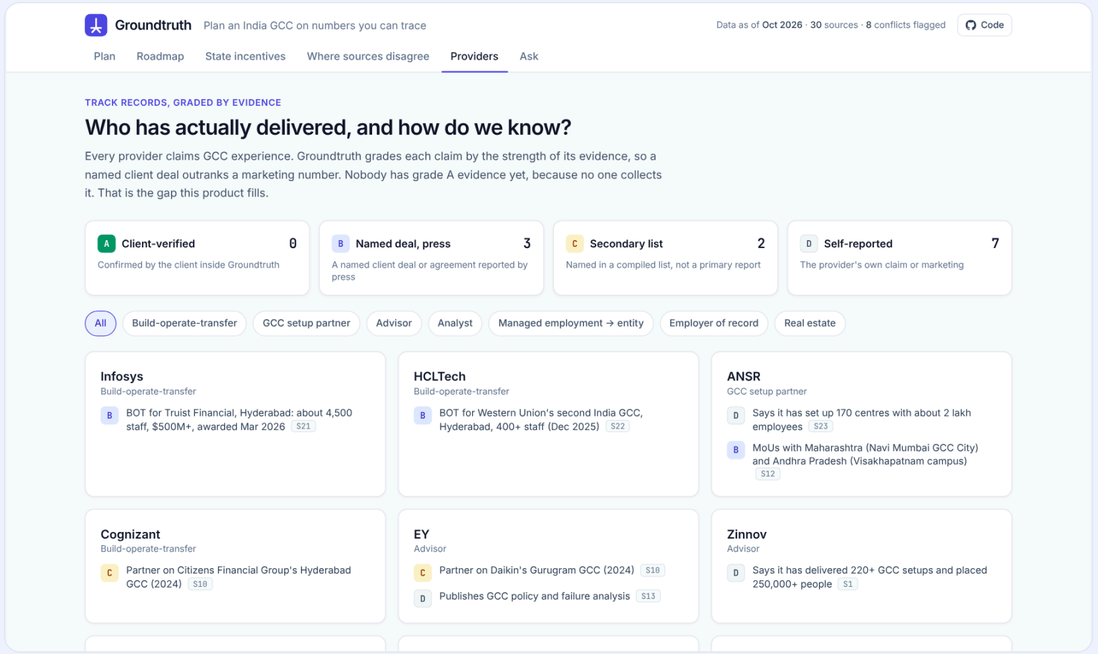
03 · SOLUTION · PROTOTYPE

Trust you can inspect



Where sources disagree

Every published value, plotted, with the default and why.



Providers, graded by evidence

A named deal outranks a marketing number. No one has grade A yet.

Also in the prototype: state incentive cards and Ask

03 · SOLUTION · DESIGN RULES

Six rules that keep it from becoming slop

Every number has a source and a date

30 linked sources. Each chip opens the register.

Disagreement is shown, not averaged

Ranges, with a stated default and the reason for it.

Assumptions look different from facts

Dashed and editable: on-costs, space per seat.

Unknown counts as zero, not a guess

Haryana, UP and Telangana score ₹0 until verified.

AI answers only from the fact base

It cites facts, and says "no data" instead of inventing.

Conflicts of interest are labelled

Flexiple is marked "this is us"; vendor sources are flagged.

All six are live in the prototype

Why each side would switch

Who	Uses today	Why they'd choose Groundtruth
First-time buyer	Big 4 advisors, paid reports, referrals	Its own numbers in minutes, free, with every source checkable
Providers	Events, content marketing, lead databases	Structured briefs at the moment of intent, and a track record that rewards real delivery
States	Roadshows, policy PDFs, MoUs	Incentives show up inside the cost math at shortlist time, plus data on who modelled them
Flexiple	GCC directory, pay data, setup service	A lead engine for GCC builds, and a data moat that grows with every plan

The neutrality question: Flexiple sells GCC setup. So ranking rules are published, Flexiple's own listing is labelled, and the buyer decides who sees a brief.

What a first-time buyer can use today

What the buyer needs	Big 4 advisor	Analyst report	GCC Explorer	Groundtruth
Built for the decision	Yes	Partly	Lists, not plans	**Yes**
Cost for my headcount	Yes, in weeks	No	No	**Yes, in minutes**
Incentive eligibility	Yes, bespoke	Partly	No	**Yes, by rule**
Conflicts shown	Rarely	No	No	**Yes**
Provider evidence	Conflicted	Paywalled	No	**Graded A–D**
Price to the buyer	Fees	$49–$6,499	Gated demo	**Free; providers pay**

Advisors stay useful for the bespoke work after the shortlist. Groundtruth gets the buyer to a good shortlist first.

Checked Oct 2026: Business of GCC ($49 report), Everest PEAK ($6,499), gccexplorer.com

05 · BUSINESS

How it earns, what we measure, what could break

Revenue

- **Buyers:** free
- **Providers:** pay per qualified brief and for evidence profiles
- **States:** demand insights
- **Flexiple:** plans become builds. A 50-person build at $299/person/month is about $15K a month

Metrics

- **North star:** plans that reach a provider brief, per week
- Plan to brief rate (hypothesis: 20%+)
- Brief to signed deal
- Share of facts under 90 days old
- Grade A evidence count

Risks and fixes

- **Neutrality:** published ranking rules, own listing labelled
- **Data decay:** every fact dated, freshness target
- **Incentive accuracy:** counsel review, "indicative" label
- **Evidence cold start:** seed grades B–D from public data, verify after each build

Build pricing: flexiple.com/gcc ($299 per person per month during the build)

05 · NEXT 90 DAYS

Validate before scaling

Weeks 1–2

Validate

- Interview 10 first-time GCC leaders, 5 providers, 2 state agencies
- Will buyers share headcount and timeline for a free plan?
- Will 1 in 5 plans ask for a brief?
- Will providers pay for briefs over lead lists?

Weeks 3–6

Ship

- Launch on flexiple.com/gcc, on the real talent graph
- Counsel-reviewed incentives for nine states
- Replace tier-2 pay estimates with real data

Weeks 7–12

Grow

- Brief pilot with 10 providers
- First grade A evidence from completed builds
- First state data partnership

Kill criterion: if fewer than 1 in 10 plans ask for a brief, rethink the wedge

GROUNDTRUTH

Scattered GCC data, turned into one decision a buyer can trust

LINKS

Prototype: groundtruth-bay.vercel.app
Code: github.com/ShubhamY2712/Groundtruth
Contact: shubham.yawalkar@adypu.edu.in

HOW THIS WAS MADE

Researched and built with heavy use of AI (Claude), as the brief asked. Every figure traces to one of 30 public sources listed in the prototype.